

treat foreign patients under medical tourism. With Meenakshi Hospital, Dr. S. Gurushankar has put Thanjavur on the global healthcare map.

A Pioneer Who Paved the Way for New Highs

Under the stewardship of Dr. S. Gurushankar, the Meenakshi Mission Hospital, Madurai, has notched several firsts to its credit. It offers quality care for patients of all age groups, from paediatrics to geriatrics, with more than 45 clinical specialities.

The hospital is the first in South-East Asia and India to acquire an Optical Coherence Tomography (OCT) machine integrated into a Cath Lab. It is also the first in South Tamil Nadu to have a robotic surgical facility and bone marrow transplant centre.

The hospital's Emergency Medicine Department is the most well-equipped and successful in the entire region.

In the Times of Covid

When the world was confronted with the ongoing pandemic, Dr. S. Gurushankar's out-of-the-box thinking and advice towards crisis management were well-received and acclaimed by everyone, including the Government. His knack for seeing opportunity in adversity led him to overcome the humongous challenges posed by the once-in-a-lifetime public health emergency.

Under Dr. S. Gurushankar's tutelage, the much-acclaimed '6-Stage Ultra Safety Program' was devised at the Meenakshi Mission Hospital to keep patients and staff safe from Covid-19. This novel initiative, a testimony to his exemplary vision and leadership skills, got Meenakshi Mission Hospital & Research Centre an award for 'Excellence in COVID Management' in August 2021. Other significant initiatives from Dr. S. Gurushankar to better combat the pandemic included installation of Teladoc health robots at the hospital, which got appreciation from the Tamil Nadu Health Secretary. Meenakshi

Mission Hospital is the first in the country to install the Teladoc health robots, which is being used by 6 out of the 10 world's best hospitals.

Help in the Midst of Destruction

Cyclones are devastating and deadly – just ask anyone who has witnessed one or been around one! In 2019, Cyclone Gaja wreaked havoc in the Delta region of Tamil Nadu. In that time of peril, Dr. S. Gurushankar helped the victims by organizing more than 125 medical camps and non-stop relief work. Apart from medical works, He also built concrete houses for people who had their dwellings washed away. He also arranged distribution of more than 10,000 coconut saplings and 1,000 coconut leaf weavings, along with essential medicines, to the needy.

Dr. S. Gurushankar's efforts and zeal to help others in time of crisis and disasters received much-deserved praise and appreciation from the Government of Tamil Nadu.

Talking Through his Philanthropy

Dr. S. Gurushankar has unmatched zeal for philanthropic work and supporting social causes. Under his guidance, Meenakshi Mission Hospital at Madurai has conducted over 13,500 free cleft lip and palate surgeries for children and provided free treatment to more than 3,000 cancer-afflicted children over the last few years.

Significantly, the Meenakshi Mission Hospital has also completed more than 150 free heart surgeries till now for the poor and the needy. It also runs one-of-a-kind scheme in which all patients at the hospital are provided meals absolutely free of charge.

Dr. S. Gurushankar has made significant donations for various charitable causes. In 2012, he contributed Rs 20 lakh towards Chief Minister's Public Relief Fund for rehabilitation of the Thane cyclone victims. In June 2021, the Meenakshi Mission Hospital donated oxygen

concentrators worth Rs 1.5 crore to the Government of Tamil Nadu and Rs 25 lakhs towards the Tamil Nadu Chief Minister's Public Relief Fund. In addition to the charity in the State of Tamilnadu, Meenakshi Mission Hospital also donated 25 oxygen concentrators to the Government of Bihar.

Appreciation from High-profile Personalities

Dr. J. Radhakrishnan, Health Secretary of Tamil Nadu, appreciated the Teladoc Health Robot's functionality deployed at the ICU and Covid-19 wards of Meenakshi Mission Hospital.

Other esteemed personalities to appreciate Dr. S. Gurushankar's work were Supreme Court Judges Hon'ble Justices Sanjay Kishan Kaul and Hon'ble Indira Banerjee. The renowned legal luminary were impressed with the free medical services provided by the hospital to patients from a poor socio-economic background, especially those who could not afford cancer treatment.

Awards and Accolades

Dr. S. Gurushankar has received several prestigious awards in over the years. In 2016, he was conferred with the 'Emerging Entrepreneur Award' by CII. He was feted with the Lifetime Achievement Award by The University of IOWA, USA, for his contribution towards rural health services in India. Yet another award presented to Dr. S. Gurushankar was the NIPM Award in 2016 for his commitment towards promoting holistic healthcare in the society. In 2021, Dr. S. Gurushankar received the Healthcare Chief Executive Officer of the Year Award at the Economic Times Health Awards.

No matter what their economic standing or income levels, the philanthropic zeal and compassion of Dr. S. Gurushankar have made affordable and quality healthcare accessible to hundreds of thousands of needy people over the years, transforming their lives for the better.